Finding 5 - Testing Snort Starter Rules (ICMP, SSH, HTTP Alerts)

Objective

Generate traffic from Kali (or another VM) and confirm Snort alerts for the three starter rules.

Snort command used on the Ubuntu VM:

```
sudo snort -A console -q -c /etc/snort/snort.conf -i <interface>
```

Test 1 - ICMP Ping (SID 1000001)

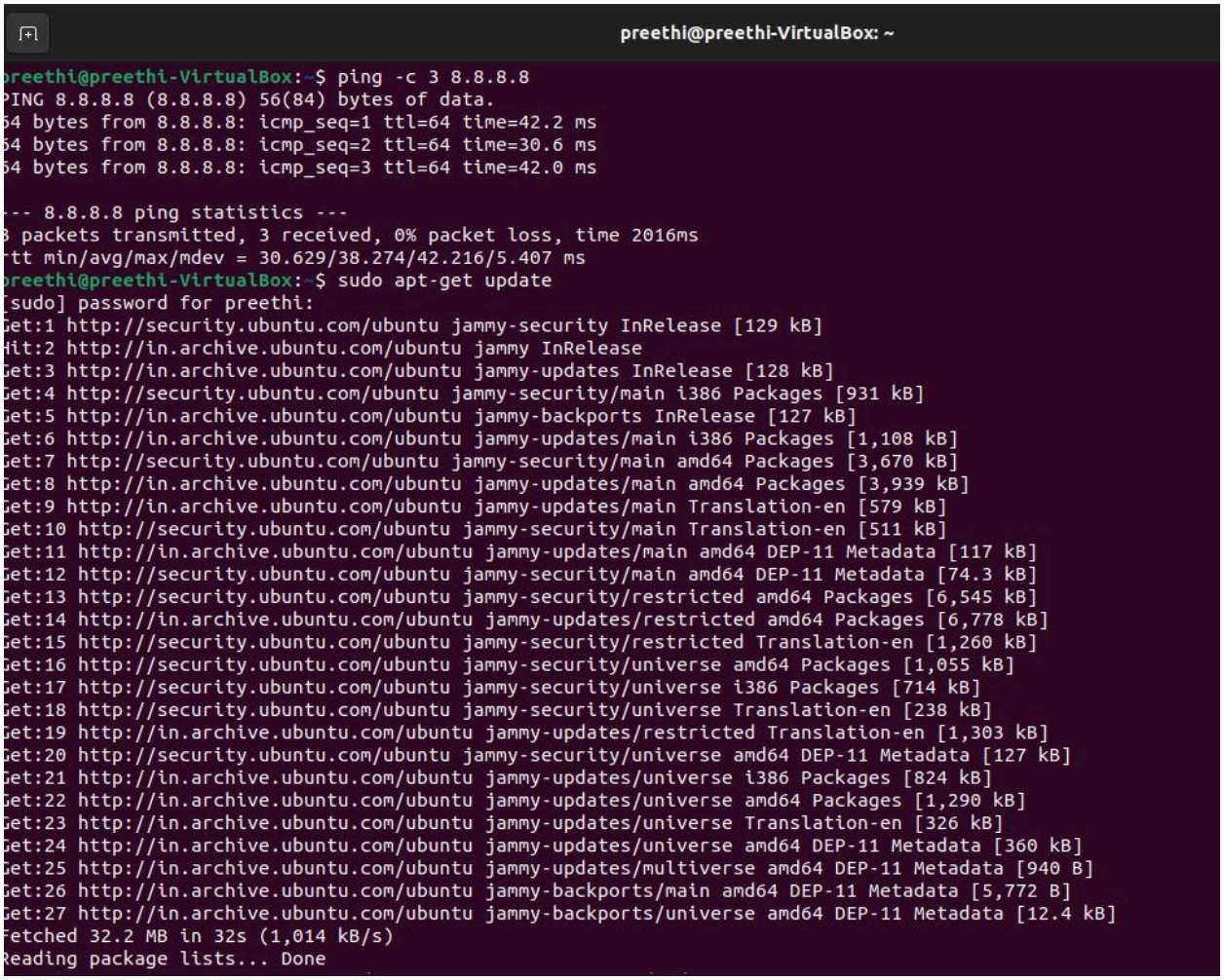
From Kali / another VM:

```
ping -c 4 <ubuntu-vm-ip>
```

Expected alert:

```
[**] [1:1000001:1] ICMP Ping Detected [**]
```

[Insert Screenshot 5.1 here - ping command on Kali]



Test 2 - SSH Connection Attempt (SID 1000002)

From Kali / another VM:

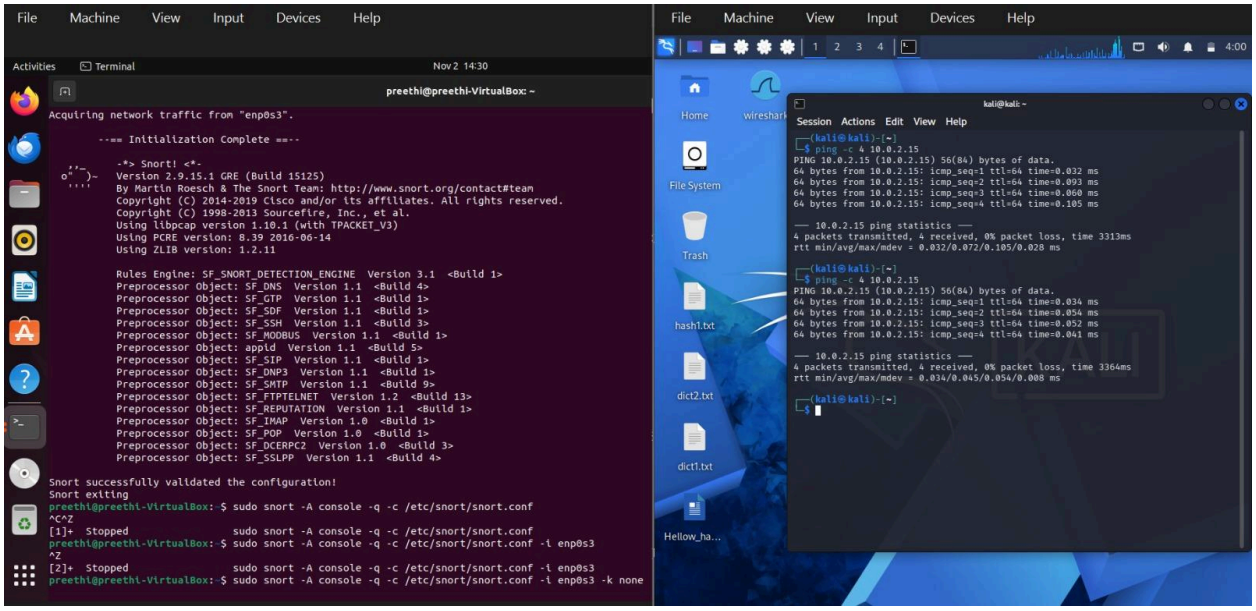
```
ssh <username>@<ubuntu-vm-ip>
```

(or `nc -zv <ubuntu-vm-ip> 22`)

Expected alert:

```
[**] [1:1000002:1] SSH Connection Attempt [**]
```

[Insert Screenshot 5.3 here - SSH attempt on Kali]



Test 3 - HTTP Traffic (SID 1000003)

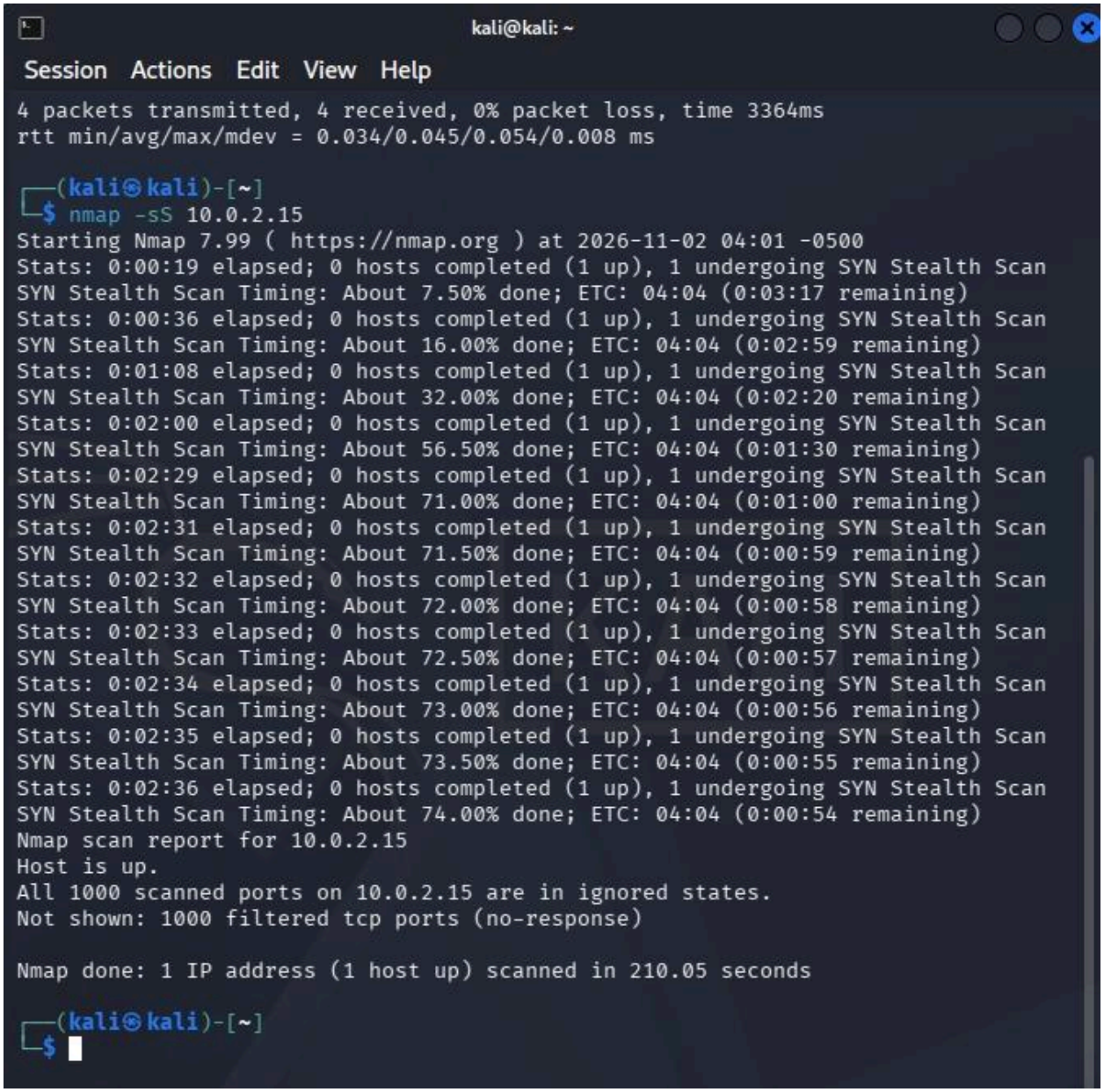
On the Ubuntu VM make sure a web server is listening (for example Apache: `sudo apt-get install -y apache2`), then from Kali:

`curl http://<ubuntu-vm-ip>`

Expected alert:

`[**] [1:1000003:1] HTTP Traffic [**]`

`[Insert Screenshot 5.5 here - curl command on Kali]`



Results summary

Test	Command from attacker VM	Rule that fired	SID	Result
Ping	`ping -c 4 <ip>`	ICMP Ping Detected	1000001	Alert generated
SSH	`ssh user@<ip>`	SSH Connection Attempt	1000002	Alert generated

Test	Command from attacker VM	Rule that fired	SID	Result
HTTP	`curl http://<ip>`	HTTP Traffic	1000003	Alert generated

Analysis

- Each rule matched the traffic it was designed for, proving the rules, configuration and interface selection are correct.
- One ping or one HTTP request produces several alerts, because these simple rules alert on every matching packet. In production, rules are refined with `flow`, `flags` or `threshold` options to reduce noise.
- Alerts include source IP, destination IP, protocol and ports, which an analyst uses to decide whether the activity is expected.

SOC relevance

These alerts show how network monitoring detects reconnaissance (ping), remote access attempts (SSH) and web access. In a real SOC the same alerts would be forwarded to a SIEM and enriched before triage.